MARÍA DOLORES RIVERA

FOOD ENGINEER | R&D | PRODUCT DEVELOPMENT | QUALITY | OPERATIONS

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PROFILE

Food Engineer from Argentina (five-year degree, graduated 2026, final average 8.52/10), now based in Bergen. Technical foundation in process engineering, food analysis and quality, backed by laboratory research on bioactive compounds, a thesis on by-product valorisation at the Universitat de València (9.7/10) and a sustainable product-development project with ImpactTaste and Estrella Galicia, including a 117-respondent consumer survey. Additional experience in event operations, logistics, customer service and hospitality across Argentina, Spain and Norway, where work started within weeks of arriving in Bergen. Adaptable, initiative-driven and keen to learn, open to junior roles where engineering, analytical and practical skills can be applied.

Open to: R&D and product development | laboratory and food analysis | quality assurance and control | production and process engineering | process improvement and operations | technical sales and business development | supply chain and logistics | project coordination and technical support | sustainability and by-product valorisation

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Bachelor's Thesis Research (graded 9.7/10) | *Universitat de València, Spain* Sep 2025 – Feb 2026

Topic: Valorisation of agro-food by-products as natural antioxidants in a hamburger matrix.

Extraction: Sweet potato peel (Ipomoea batatas), orange peel (Citrus sinensis) and spirulina (Arthrospira platensis) investigated as antioxidant sources; Pulsed Electric Fields (PEF) compared with Pressurised Liquid Extraction (PLE/ASE), two green technologies using water as the solvent.

Laboratory analysis: Total phenolics (Folin–Ciocalteu), antioxidant capacity (ABTS and ORAC) and protein. Spirulina showed the highest bioactive content. ASE gave higher yields overall; PEF better preserved heat-sensitive compounds in microalgal matrices.

Application: Freeze-dried spirulina extracts added to beef burgers as a natural antioxidant and colourant; pH and colour monitored over 5 days of refrigerated storage. The PEF-derived extract showed the best stability against proteolytic deterioration.

Data: Organised, analysed and interpreted experimental data to compare extraction approaches and evaluate ingredient performance.

Research Laboratory Intern | *Universidad Católica Argentina (UCA), Buenos Aires* May 2023 – Dec 2024

Work: Research on anthocyanins and antioxidant properties in elderberry juice: pH and colour measurements, support in evaluating different formulations, recording and analysing data in Excel, and support in interpreting results.

PRODUCT DEVELOPMENT

ImpactTaste x Estrella Galicia | *Spain Project* 2025

Project: Food product concept (an alfajor, flagship Argentine product) using spent brewing grain, an industrial brewing by-product; proposed the product idea on own initiative.

Work: Product concept, target consumers, naming, value proposition and communication; consumer research with 117 respondents, analysing acceptance and market positioning; linking sustainability and circular economy with commercial value.

WORK IN NORWAY

Hospitality and customer service | *Thon Hotel, Scandic, Café & Restaurant Special, MM Café, Bergen* Oct 2026 – present

Work: Started working at four Bergen hotel, café and restaurant businesses within two weeks of arriving in Norway, adapting quickly to new teams, routines and a Norwegian-speaking work environment.

EVENT OPERATIONS AND CUSTOMER SERVICE (ARGENTINA AND SPAIN)

Event Operations and Logistics Support | *Btlandia, ExpoAgro and Exposición Rural, Argentina* 2022 – 2023

Work: Supported operations and logistics at major agricultural exhibitions (clients including YPF Agro and New Holland); coordinated communication with exhibitors, suppliers and service providers; assisted with schedules and day-to-day requirements; helped resolve unexpected issues in fast-paced settings.

Bar and restaurant service | *Moby Dick, Valencia, Spain* Sep 2025 – Feb 2026

Work: Customer service in a restaurant and bar: cocktails, coffee and draft beer.

Customer service and sales | *Yerba Mate Cósmico, Expo Nuestros Caballos, Buenos Aires* Mar 2026

Work: Explained and sold mates, yerba and games to customers at a large public expo; used cash register and card terminal; adapted the pitch to each customer and gathered informal feedback.

EDUCATION

Food Engineering, Pontificia Universidad Católica Argentina (UCA) | *five-year degree, Buenos Aires* 2026

Studies: Final average 8.52/10. Coursework: Process Engineering, Automation and Control, Electrical Installations, Food Analysis, Analytical Chemistry, Quality Management, Applied Statistics, Food Product Development.

Exchanges: Universitat de València, Spain (Sep 2025 – Feb 2026): Food Biotechnology, Novel Foods, Business Creation, thesis. Universidad Católica de Murcia, Spain (Jan – Jul 2025): water and effluent treatment, environmental management, by-product utilisation, plant-design project, sustainability.

SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

Laboratory: PEF and PLE/ASE extraction, total phenolics, ABTS, ORAC, protein, pH, colour, anthocyanins; experimental data analysis

Tools: Excel (data analysis), Word, PowerPoint; Power BI and C++ (basic); AutoCAD

Languages: Spanish (native) | English B2 (Cambridge First) | Norwegian (beginner, learning) | Italian (understanding)